root@deadface:~# cat writeup.txt

Chatty Cathy

DEADFACE CTF // OSINT // web recon

category	OSINT, web enumeration (bonus: image geolocation)
start	https://ghosttown.deadface.io/
target	https://170.187.156.131:8443/
person	forum user **lamia415**
result	hidden path /secret_members found through robots.txt

[00] Route

#	what	outcome
01	search the GhostTown forum	link to lamia415's travel blog
02	read the blog	two posts, a broken image, a hint about "both profiles"
03	robots.txt	/secret_members
bonus	hidden image + geolocation	Naxos, Greece (optional, not needed to solve)

[01] Forum recon

GhostTown is the DEADFACE community forum: 15 operators, 57 topics, 688 posts, split into Announcements, General, Tech Talk and a few more. Reading it all is a waste of time, so I went straight for the search box.

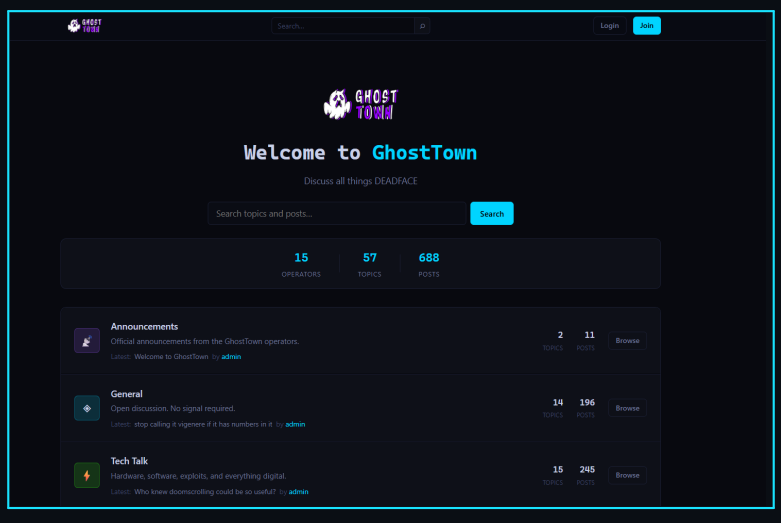


fig.1 // GhostTown front page

The task talks about a travel blog, so the keyword was travel. Five hits. Most were Tech Talk noise, but two mattered: the thread **Travel Destinations** in OFF-GRID, started by lamia415, and a reply

with a link: https://170.187.156.131:8443/.

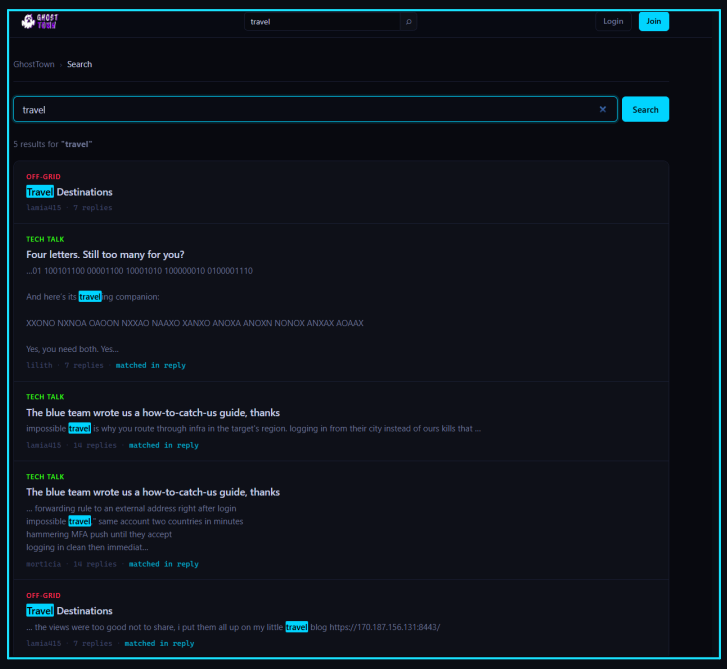


fig.2 // search results for "travel"

The thread itself is the whole story:

> **lamia415** says she went "off grid" and posted the entire trip anyway, from her favorite spot in the world.

> **sunstalker** calls her a hypocrite. She admits to old habits and drops the link to her travel blog.

> **luciafer** points out her first name is on the blog. Her answer: "nothing links back to me".

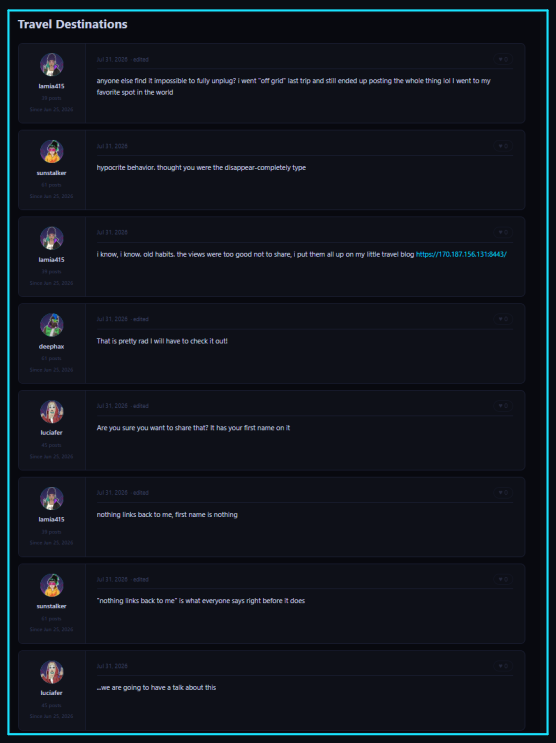


fig.3 // Travel Destinations thread



fig.4 // the post with the blog link

[02] The blog

The link opens **Wander with Alice** ("chasing sunsets, one boarding pass at a time"). Two posts. The first is about a holiday at her favorite restaurant, and the photo that goes with it does not load.



fig.5 // blog front page

The intro text is the useful part. She says she will keep posting **on both profiles, in case this stops working**. So the blog is not what it looks like, and the site is worth poking at.

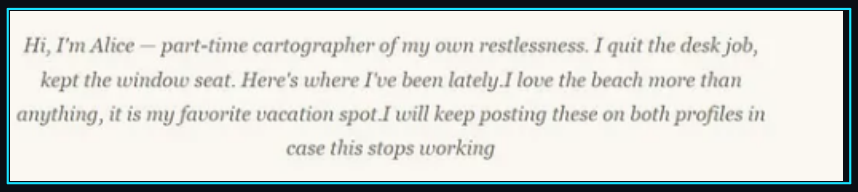


fig.6 // intro text

[03] robots.txt

Before touching the broken image, the cheapest check on any web target: `robots.txt`.

```
$ curl -k https://170.187.156.131:8443/robots.txt
```

Response:

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /secret_members
```

The file is meant to keep crawlers away, but it also hands over a list of what the owner wants hidden. Here that is `/secret_members`, a members-only section.

[BONUS] Hidden resource and photo geolocation

> **Optional.** The challenge is solvable without any of this. It is a side trail, but a fun one, and it shows how much a single photo can leak.

hidden resource

The image on the first post would not render, so I opened dev tools (Resources) to see what the page was asking for:

```
https://170.187.156.131:8443/static/other1.png      # does not load
```

Dropping the `1` from the filename got the picture:

```
https://170.187.156.131:8443/static/other.png       # works
```

The server returns the missing photo: a narrow street, whitewashed buildings, a cafe with a sign, road signs. Very Mediterranean.

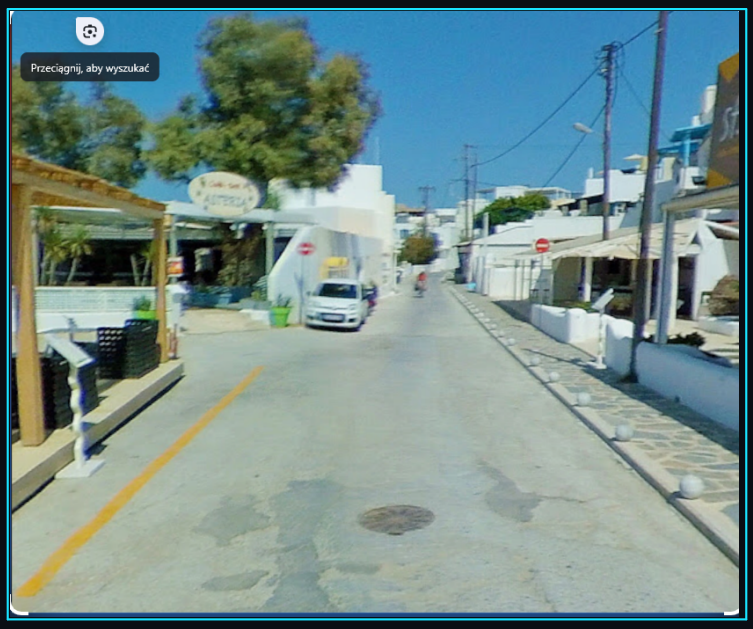


fig.7 // image recovered from /static/other.png

geolocation

A reverse image search (Google Lens) matched the photo to a page on `greek-tourism.com` showing **Agios Georgios, Naxos, Greece**. The cafe sign and the street layout line up.

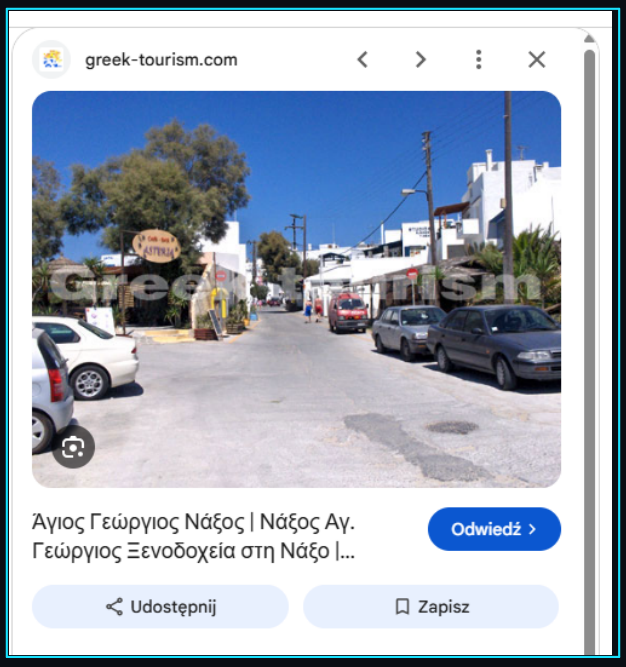


fig.8 // reverse image search match

The image metadata holds GPS coordinates:

```
37.100007, 25.400074
```

On a map that is **Villa Parisi, Naxos**. It confirms the place, and it is a **dead end**: no flag there. What it did show is that the server answers when you play with the URL, which is why I went back and enumerated it properly in step 03.

[EOF] Toolbox

forum search, browser dev tools, URL tweaking, `robots.txt`, and for the bonus: Google Lens + EXIF + a map.

> **Moral:** check the easiest things first, before digging deeper. Photos, metadata and coordinates were a nice detour, but a three second look at `/robots.txt` was all it took.